



Developer Workforce & Compensation Trends

2024 Stack Overflow Survey

65,437 respondents across 180+ countries

Source: survey.stackoverflow.co/2024/work

84% of Developers Are Working, but Full-Time Employment Dips in the U.S.

69%

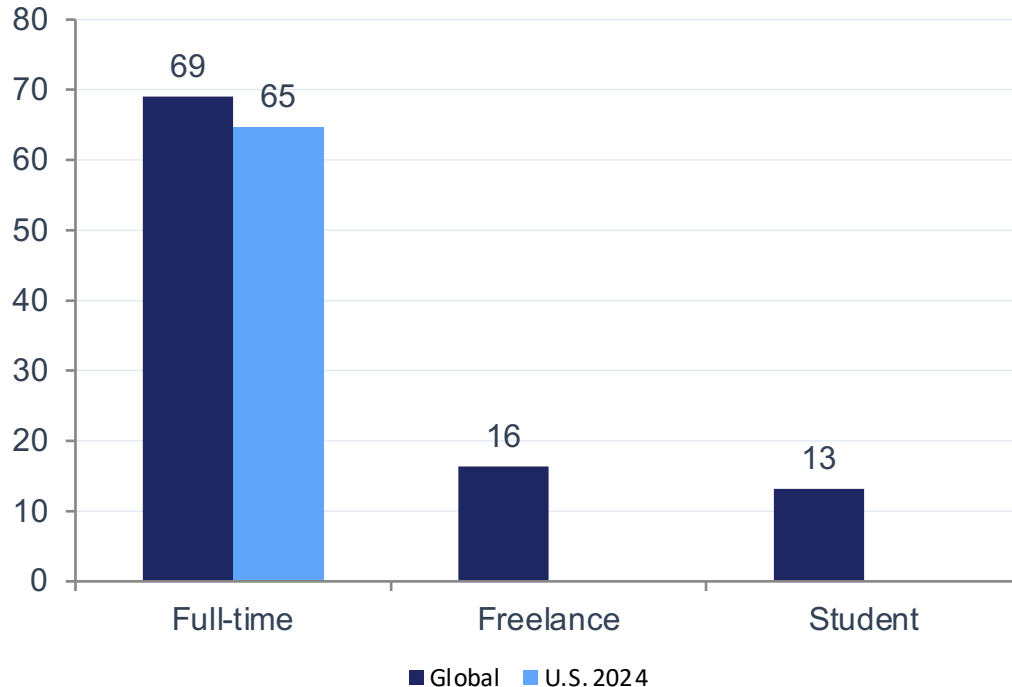
Full-time employment (global)

16.4%

Independent contracting / freelancing

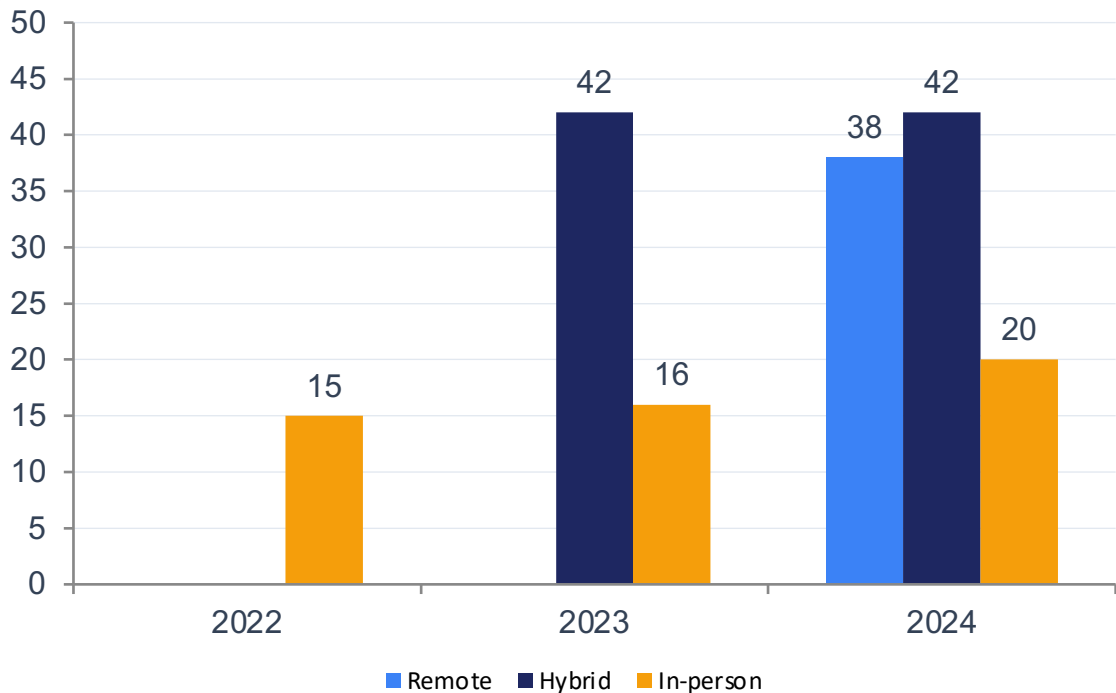
13.2%

Full-time students



U.S. full-time employment dropped from 69% in 2023 to 64.8% in 2024. In the U.K. and Ukraine, non-full-time respondents lean toward independent contracting; in Germany and India, they are more likely to be students.

In-Person Work Rises to 20% While Hybrid Holds Steady at 42%



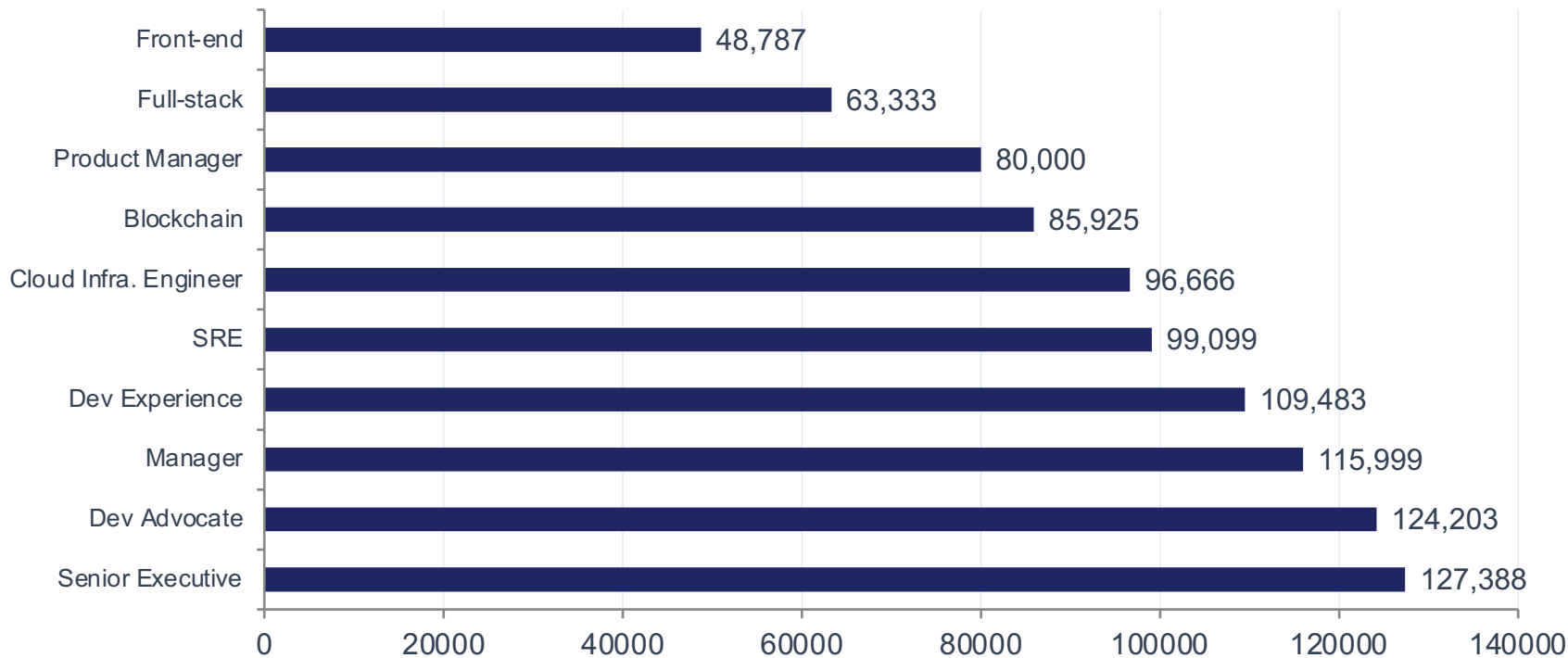
42%

Hybrid — most common arrangement, unchanged from 2023

+5pp

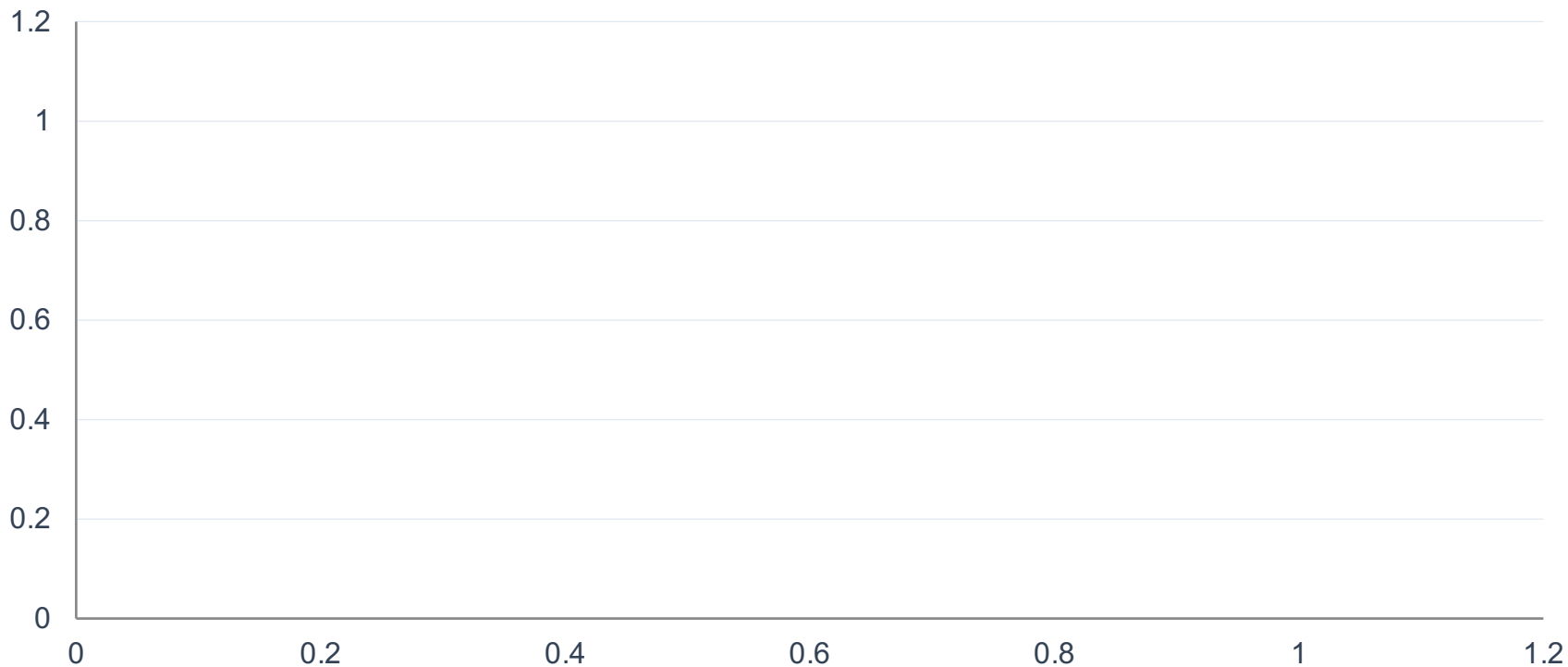
In-person growth since 2022 (15% → 20%), third consecutive yearly rise

Senior Executives and Dev Advocates Top \$124K+ Median Salary



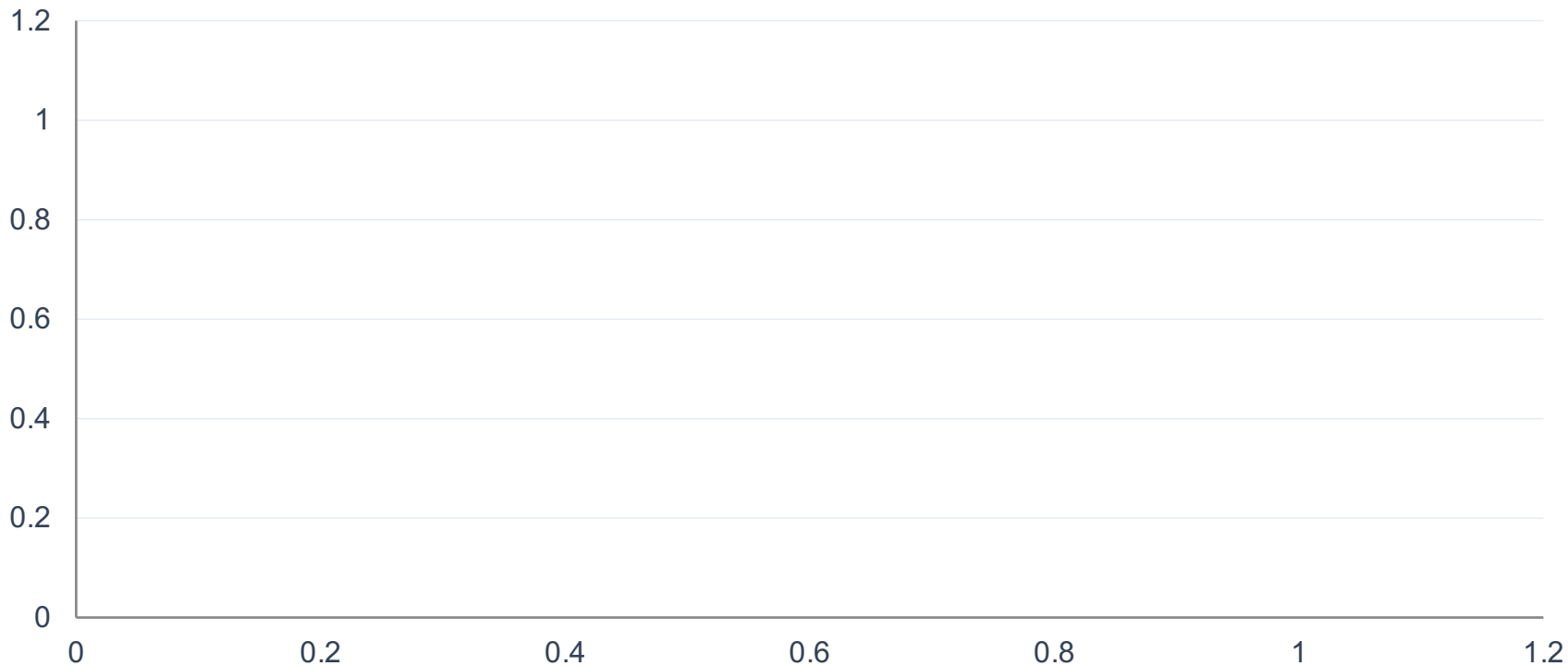
Source: 22,677 salary responses (34.7% response rate). Reference: figure_1.jpg

Experience Pays: Top Roles Combine 14+ Years with Six-Figure Salaries



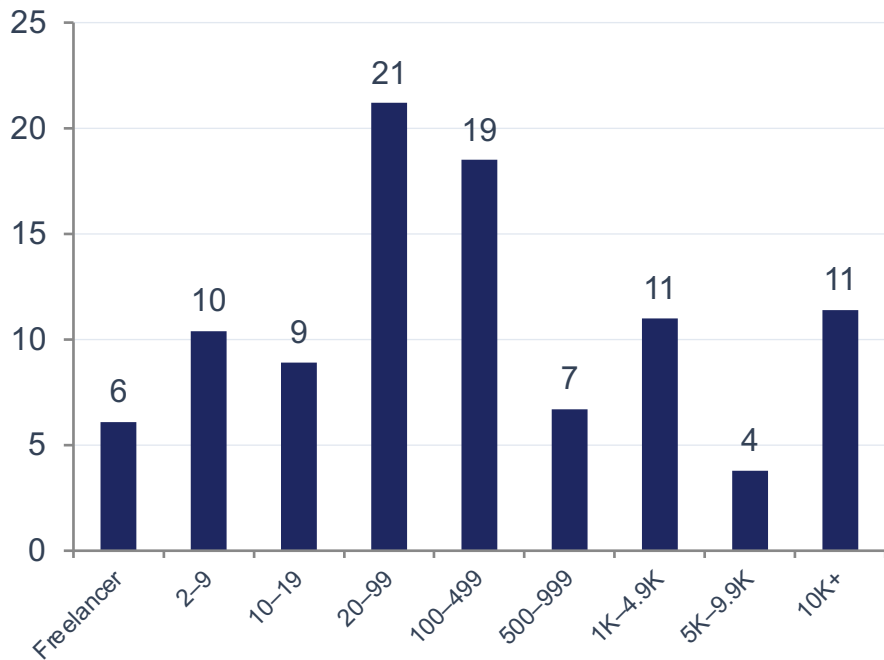
Reference: figure_2.jpg. Senior roles cluster in the upper-right; Student is a clear outlier at \$15K / ~2 years.

Erlang & Clojure Developers Earn >\$95K; Dart & Prolog Below \$45K



Reference: figure_3.jpg. Overall reported salary range dropped ~\$10K vs. 2023 (\$60–75K vs. \$70–85K).

47% Work at Sub-100 Orgs; 62% Influence Tech Purchases



62%

of respondents have influence over technology purchases at their organizations

60%

prefer a build-and-buy approach

Top influencers:

- Senior executives — 99%
- Engineering managers — 87%
- Product managers — 77%

Takeaways: What These Trends Mean for Hiring & Retention

- 1 Full-time employment is softening**
U.S. full-time fell 4pp YoY to 64.8%. Plan workforce strategies that embrace contractors and freelancers (16%+ globally).
- 2 In-person mandates are growing — but hybrid still dominates**
In-person rose to 20% (third consecutive yearly increase). Yet 42% remain hybrid; rigid RTO policies risk attrition.
- 3 DevRel and SRE roles command premium pay**
Senior Executives (\$127K), Dev Advocates (\$124K), and SREs (\$99K) top the charts. Expect competition for experienced DevRel and infrastructure talent.
- 4 Language choice correlates with pay — niche languages pay more**
Erlang (~\$97K), Clojure (~\$95K), and Elixir (~\$93K) outearn mainstream JavaScript (~\$64K) and PHP (~\$49K). Niche skill premiums remain strong despite a ~\$10K overall market drop.
- 5 Most developers influence purchasing — engage them directly**
62% have a say in tech buying. Vendor strategies should target individual contributors, not just management. Free trials (75%) and peer recommendations (73%) are the top evaluation channels.

Source: Stack Overflow Developer Survey 2024 (survey.stackoverflow.co/2024/work)